

YIXIAO SUN

404 Wilson Road, Room 557
East Lansing, MI 48824
Website: sun-yixiao.com
Email: sunyixi2@msu.edu
Update: September 2026

EDUCATION

Michigan State University Ph.D. in Communication Advisor: David M. Markowitz	East Lansing, MI 2025–
Nanjing University M.A. in Communication Advisor: Cheng-Jun Wang; GPA: 4.0/4.0	Nanjing, China 2022–2025
Sichuan International Studies University B.A. in Internet and New Media (Graduated with Highest Distinction) Advisor: Hao Liu; GPA: 3.96/4.0	Chongqing, China 2018–2022

PROFESSIONAL TRAININGS

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan Coursework in Bayesian modeling, time-series and panel analysis, and quantitative foundations	Ann Arbor, MI Summer 2026
--	------------------------------

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [5] Markowitz, D. M., & **Sun, Y.** (2026). Language and Persuasion Research: A Computational Literature Review Spanning Five Decades of Scholarship (1974–2025). *Social and Personality Psychology Compass*, 20(9), e70171.
- [4] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Lu, G., Chen, Z., & Wang, C. J. (2025). Let Us Not Wallow in the Valley of Despair: The Role of Emotion, Panic, and Sympathy Discourses in Promoting Productive Actions. *International Journal of Business Communication*, 63(4), 1431–1455.
- [3] Zhang, Y.[†], **Sun, Y.**[†], & Wang, C. J. (2025). Unraveling the Shape of Social Media Narratives: Analyzing the Effects of Online Interaction and Narrative Structure on Attention to Digital Asset Transactions. *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media*, 69(3), 200–218. [**Co-first author**[†]]
- [2] Chen, Z., Yu, W., **Sun, Y.**, Wang, C. J., & Liu, X. F. (2025). The Dark Side of the Internet: Fueling Misinformation in the COVID-19 Pandemic and the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election. *Communication and the Public*, 11(2), 160–181.
- [1] **Sun, Y.**, Yan, X. F., Zhang, Y., Chen, J., Chen, Z., & Wang, C. J. (2024). Globalization in International Tensions: The Impact of Military Conflicts on the Cultural Orientations of Multinational Corporations' Advertising in Modern China (1932–1937). *Chinese Journal of Communication*, 17(4), 452–470.

UNDER REVIEW

- [9] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (Revise & Resubmit). Bipolarity of Positive and Negative Affects: Contemporaneous Network Relations of Nuanced Affect States. *Cognition and Emotion*.
- [8] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (Revise & Resubmit). Inside Right-Wing Authoritarianism: Item-Level Dynamics with COVID-19 Fear and Prevention Beliefs. *British Journal of Social Psychology*.
- [7] **Sun, Y.**, & Markowitz, D. M. (Under Review). How Conspiratorial Predispositions Amplify Winner-Loser Polarization in Perceived Electoral Legitimacy.
- [6] **Sun, Y.**, Markowitz, D. M., & Bailenson, J. N. (Under Review). A Guide for Studying Language Use in Virtual and Augmented Reality. In A. Atay & D. L. Fassett (Eds.), *Communication and Education With AI*. Cognella Academic Publishing.
- [5] **Sun, Y.**, Markowitz, D. M., Zhang, Y., & Wang, C. J. (Under Review). Behind the Roles We Play: How U.S. Politicians' Social Media Narrative Identity Relates to Their Dissent Voting Behavior.
- [4] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (Under Review). Phenomenal Consciousness in Females and Access Consciousness in Males Are More Closely Associated with Emotions.
- [3] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, & Wang, C. J. (Under Review). Narrative Road to Fame: The Roles of Online Interaction, Network Structure, and Narrative Identity in Shaping Cross-Platform Popularity of U.S. Senators (2015–2025).
- [2] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Yan, L., Yan, X. F., & Wang, C. J. (Under Review). Is National Identity Harmless to Ingroup Members? Leveraging Ingroup Favoritism and Moral Foundation to Promote Online Fandom Donation.
- [1] Zhang, Y., Xiao, X., **Sun, Y.**, & Wang, C. J. (Under Review). Who Leads the Framing of Grassroots Sports on Social Media? Frame and Emotional Activation Across Government, Media, and Public Actors.

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

- [6] **Sun, Y.**, Markowitz, D. M., & Eden, A. L. Character Arcs: Measuring Protagonist Agency Trajectories and Their Differential Effects on Narrative Success.
- [5] **Sun, Y.**, & Markowitz, D. M. Text Analysis of Social Media Content. In M. A. Hamilton (Ed.), *Handbook of Research Methods in Communication Studies*. Edward Elgar Publishing Ltd.
- [4] **Sun, Y.**, Zhang, J., & Markowitz, D. M. Softening the Blow? Euphemistic Framing in Disaster Warnings Attenuates Threat Perception and Protective Action Intention.
- [3] **Sun, Y.**, Zhang, X. & Markowitz, D. M. Asymmetrical Reciprocity in Human-LLM Relationships: Resource Exchange, Attachment, and Dependence.
- [2] Song, M., **Sun, Y.** Gendered Self-Presentation in Campaign Biographies and Electoral Success in U.S. House Elections.
- [1] Wang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Tamborini, R. Sensation Seeking Dictionary (SSD): Developing A Theory-Driven NLP Tool for Communication Research.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[10] **Sun, Y.** (2026, November). Behind the Roles We Play: How U.S. Politicians’ Social Media Narrative Identity Relates to Their Dissent Voting Behavior. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 112th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA.

[9] Wang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Tamborini, R., Cabadas, I., & McCollom, L. (2026, September). Sensation Seeking Dictionary (SSD): Developing A Theory-Driven NLP Tool for Communication Research. Poster presented at the *Communication Science Futures 2026 Conference*, East Lansing, MI.

[8] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (2025, November). Bipolarity of Positive and Negative Affects: Contemporaneous Network Relations of Nuanced Affect States. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention*, Denver, CO.

[7] Li, W., **Sun, Y.**, & Yue, Y. (2025, November). Artificial Intelligence vs. Medical Experts: A Comparative Analysis of Semantic Quality and Readability in Health Advice from Large Language Models and Human Institutions. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention*, Denver, CO.

[6] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (2024, November). Authoritarians in Response to Societal Crises: Reciprocal Dynamics of Right-Wing Authoritarianism, COVID-19 Fear and Prevention Belief. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA. [Top Paper Award]

[5] **Sun, Y.**, Fei, Y., & Yu, C. (2024, November). Resource Exchange, Perceived Social Support, Companionship and Intimacy: Characterizing the Social Relationship Between Users and ChatGPT. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA. [Top Student Paper Award]

[4] **Sun, Y.** (2024, November). Building Identity Through Narratives: Who Voices Dissent Within the Party?. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA.

[3] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Chen, Z., & Wang, C. J. (2024, November). How Emotion and Narrative Foster Resilience in Adversity: The Case of Large-Scale Online Donations during COVID-19. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA.

[2] **Sun, Y.**, Yan, X. F., Zhang, Y., Chen, Z., & Wang, C. J. (2023, May). From Imperialism to Cultural Imperialism: Localized Versus Globalized Advertisements of Imported Commodities in China (1932–1937). Paper presented at the *73rd Annual International Communication Association (ICA) Conference*, Toronto, Canada.

[1] Zhang, Y., Lu, G., **Sun, Y.**, Chen, Z., & Wang, C. J. (2023, May). Traversing the Valley of Despair in Affective Mobilization: Issue Engagement, Emotion, and Online Donation on Sina Weibo During the Outbreak of the COVID-19 Pandemic. Paper presented at the *73rd Annual International Communication Association (ICA) Conference*, Toronto, Canada.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

HRCC Lions Research Team, Michigan State University	East Lansing, MI
Student Affiliate	Sep 2026–
Computation & Communication Lab, Michigan State University	East Lansing, MI
Student Member	Aug 2025–
Computational Communication Collaboratory, Nanjing University	Nanjing, China

Student Member / Student Affiliate

Sep 2021–

Chongqing Overseas Publicity Research Center
Global Public Opinion Research Intern

Chongqing, China
May 2020–May 2022

SELECTED HONORS and AWARDS

Research and Academic Excellence

- Top Paper Award Jul 2024
Political Communication Division, National Communication Association (NCA)
- Top Student Paper Award Jul 2024
Human Communication and Technology Division, National Communication Association (NCA)
- Chongqing Excellent Graduation Thesis Award Jan 2023

Competitive External Scholarships and Fellowships

- National Scholarship for Graduate Students, ¥20,000 Oct 2024
- HUANG Jianliang Scholarship, ¥5,000 Oct 2023
- National Scholarship for Undergraduate Students, ¥8,000 Dec 2021

Competition Awards

- National Second Place, *Dissemination Data Mining Competition* Sep 2023
- First Place in West China, *ESG National College Innovation Competition* Dec 2021
- Provincial Second Prize, *Challenge Cup National Academic Works Competition* Aug 2021
- Provincial Third Prize, *National Advertising Art Competition* Jul 2021
- National Third Prize, *National English Competition for College Students* Nov 2020

Graduation Honors

- Chongqing Distinguished Honor Graduate Award Jun 2022

GRANTS

External

- National Social Science Foundation of China (22BXW032), ¥200,000, *Research Fellow* 2022–2025
Project title: *Computational Narrative Research on Chinese Stories and Chinese Voices in the Digital Media Era* (PI: Cheng-Jun Wang)
- CAST Science Popularization Program (KXYJS2022063), ¥30,000, *co-PI* 2022–2024
Project title: *The Dissemination of Science Popularizing Information in Public Health Emergencies and Its Impact on Social Mobilization* (co-PI: Yaotian Zhang)

- Chongqing College Students' Innovation Training Program (S202010650015), ¥2,500, *PI* 2020–2021
Project title: *Research on the Visualization of Public Opinions along the Belt and Road from the Perspective of Geopolitics: Twitter as an Example*

Internal

- Distinguished Postgraduate Talent Cultivation Program (2023GYB08), ¥10,000, *PI* 2023–2025
Project title: *Research on Advertising Strategies for Imported Commodities during the Republic of China from the Perspective of Cultural Imperialism*

Travel Grants

- Graduate Office Fellowship (GOF), \$2,250 2026
- Graduate Office Fellowship (GOF), \$2,000 2025
- National Communication Association (NCA) Student Caucus Travel Grant, \$200 2024

TEACHING

Primary Instructor

COM 100: Human Communication, Michigan State University Summer 2026
Undergraduate lecture

Teaching Assistant

COM 100: Human Communication, Michigan State University Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Dr. Dustin Carnahan

Applications of Large Language Models in Digital Humanities, Nanjing University Spring 2025
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Dr. Zhihao Ma

Text Data Analysis, Nanjing University Spring 2024
Graduate lecture; Instructor: Dr. Zhicong Chen

Planning and Creative Strategy, Nanjing University Spring 2024
Graduate seminar; Instructor: Dr. Zhihao Ma

Advertising Strategy and Creation, Nanjing University Fall 2023, Fall 2024
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Dr. Zhihao Ma

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Service to Universities and Departments

Michigan State University

Undergraduate Affairs Committee Sep 2026–Aug 2027
— Advise the Department of Communication on issues pertaining to undergraduate programs.

Dean's Advisory Committee Sep 2025–Aug 2026
— Advise the dean on matters of the College of Communication Arts and Sciences.

Service to Academic Associations

National Communication Association (NCA)

- Graduate Student/IDEA Representative, *Communication Anxiety and Apprehension Division* Jan 2026–Dec 2026
— Represent graduate student members, promote IDEA initiatives, manage division social media, and facilitate communication between the division and graduate student community.
- Information Officer, *Human Communication and Technology Division* Jan 2025–Dec 2026
— Manage division communications and oversee social media engagement.

Service to Academic Media Platforms

- Data Visualization Editor, *Fact-Checking Records* Oct 2022–Jan 2024
— Edit data-driven news content, including topic development, research, writing, data analysis, and visual design.
- Editor, *Computational Communication Academy* Sep 2022–Aug 2023
— Compile and disseminate computational social science research; author newsletters highlighting developments from the Computational Communication Collaboratory.

Ad Hoc Reviewer for Academic Journals

- Computers in Human Behavior Reports* 2025
Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking 2026
New Ideas in Psychology 2025

SKILLS

- **Statistical Programming / Markup Languages:** Python, R, Stata, LaTeX, HTML, SQL, CSS, SPSS
- **Applications:** Tableau, Gephi, Brackets, Photoshop, Premier Pro, Animate, Audition
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Proficient), Japanese (Elementary)
- **Music:** Piano (Level 8 Certificate), Singing